

A glimpse at our past projects:

(Each project should have photos, a video, or other interactive media with it.)

Bridging Gaps in Arab Media: *Connecting Newsrooms and the Next Generation*
April 2023, hosted at the Asfari Institute in Beirut, Lebanon.

We brought together 25 students from the American University of Beirut and the Lebanese American University with journalists from leading international and regional outlets, including the Associated Press, Al Jazeera, and L'Orient-Le Jour.

This roundtable created a rare space for open exchange between those producing the news and those consuming it. Together, participants explored how the MENA media landscape is shifting, particularly the growing generational divide in how news is accessed, interpreted, and trusted.

Students engaged directly with key concepts such as agenda-setting, framing, and critical media literacy. At the same time, journalists gained first-hand insight into Gen Z's digital-first habits and their reliance on emerging social platforms.

The discussion also addressed the broader consequences of information disorder, highlighting its ripple effects on civic and political freedoms in the region. The session concluded with a set of shared reflections and practical recommendations for bridging these gaps moving forward.

Media Spring Workshop: *Equipping early-career Journalists & storytellers with Tools to Navigate Information Disorder*
July 2023, hosted at Amideast Tunisia, Tunis.

Held July 7–9, 2023, the Media Spring workshop brought together 17 early-career Tunisian journalists and storytellers for an intensive, hands-on training experience.

The workshop began by examining the real-world impact of misinformation on civic engagement in Tunisia. Using COVID-19 vaccine uptake in underserved rural areas as a case study, participants examined how limited access to reliable local media can shape public behavior and trust.

Participants received training in core investigative reporting skills, including information gathering, verification techniques, and the use of accessible OSINT (Open-Source Intelligence) tools, as well as an introduction to solutions journalism in partnership with the [Solutions Journalism Network](#).

The program culminated in an interactive pitching session, where each participant identified a pressing local issue and developed a proposal for a print or multimedia investigation.

Anti-Xenophobic Speech Action Brief: *Researching and Responding to Digital Hate*

In response to the surge in violence against sub-Saharan migrants in Tunisia, we developed a 2024 Anti-Xenophobic Speech Action Brief.

This project combined research on misinformation and online hate speech with expert interviews and testimonies from affected communities. Our goal was to examine how digital narratives can contribute to real-world harm, using case studies including the rise in anti-sub-Saharan violence in Tunisia and patterns of online hate targeting migrant domestic workers in Lebanon.

The brief maps key trends in online xenophobic discourse, examines its societal consequences, and outlines community-driven strategies to counter harmful narratives and promote safer, more inclusive digital spaces.

This work was recognized for its impact by the Middle East Partnership Initiative (MEPI), which awarded El Media Lab the first-place Community Service Award in June 2024.